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Subject: [External] AI Action Plan | Small Business Focus
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Greetings,

In response to the White House's Request for Information (RFI) on the development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan, Two Rivers AI Consulting submits the following comments, focusing on enhancing access and education for small businesses to effectively leverage AI in addressing uncertainty and resource constraints.

[Two Rivers AI Consulting](#) is a firm led by AI longtimer [Karin Jenson](#) that is focused solely on [bringing AI to Central Michigan](#) family and privately owned small businesses.

1. Importance of AI Adoption for Small Businesses

Small businesses are critical to the survival of the middle class and the U.S. economy, contributing significantly to innovation and employment. However, they often face challenges such as limited resources and heightened uncertainty. AI offers tools that can help mitigate these issues by improving efficiency, decision-making, and competitiveness. For instance, AI can assist in forecasting inventory levels, evaluating customer preferences, and optimizing operations.

2. Current State of AI Adoption

Recent studies indicate a growing interest among small businesses in adopting AI technologies. Approximately 23% of small businesses currently utilize AI in some capacity, with an additional 39% planning to integrate AI tools in the near future. Despite this interest, many small businesses encounter barriers such as lack of expertise, financial constraints, and uncertainty about implementation.

3. Recommendations for Enhancing AI Access and Education

a. Develop Targeted Educational Programs

Establish accessible educational initiatives that provide small business owners and their employees with the knowledge and skills necessary to implement AI solutions. These programs should include practical workshops, online courses, and certification opportunities tailored to various industries and levels of technical proficiency. For example, Estonia's national initiative, AI Leap, aims to teach AI skills to high school students in collaboration with tech companies, preparing them for future jobs and promoting critical thinking. Vice President Vance alluded to this type of training in schools in his Paris speech, but it must also be available to the American workforce.

b. Provide Financial Incentives and Support

Introduce grants, subsidies, or tax incentives to reduce the financial burden associated with adopting AI technologies. This support can help small businesses invest in necessary infrastructure, software, and training. Additionally, public-private partnerships can facilitate affordable access to AI tools and resources.

c. Foster Collaborative Communities and Networks

Encourage the formation of networks and communities where small businesses can share experiences, challenges, and best practices related to AI adoption. Such collaboration can demystify AI technologies and promote peer-to-peer learning. For instance, entrepreneurs have leveraged local networks to discover new AI use cases and overcome barriers to sustained use .

d. Ensure Ethical and Inclusive AI Practices

Develop guidelines and frameworks to ensure that AI implementation is ethical, transparent, and inclusive. This includes addressing potential biases in AI algorithms and ensuring that AI tools do not disproportionately disadvantage certain groups. The White House’s executive order on AI emphasizes the need for safeguards to improve the security of AI development and usage.

4. Conclusion

By implementing these strategies, the AI Action Plan can empower small businesses to harness AI effectively, thereby enhancing their resilience against uncertainty and resource limitations. Two Rivers AI Consulting is committed to supporting these efforts and is prepared to collaborate with stakeholders to advance AI accessibility and education for small businesses.

We appreciate the opportunity to contribute to this important initiative and look forward to the positive impact it will have on the small business community.

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